HELIOS INSTRUMENTS

First two weeks

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To the CIO. Monday, November 2, 2026. About 60 hours.

The queue

Re-assign and close go out first. 1-3 are the tickets I will handle initially.

Mine	Request	Call	Who	Why
	R7 Lukas, Hannover WiFi	Re-assign	Infra	Hardware/On-site Connectivity falls under Infra. Push it to the Infra queue and project-manage the fix. Orders have to arrive and product has to ship.
	R1 Dana, pipeline dashboard	Re-assign	Data Platform	Data team specializes in Company dashboards, this is part of that role. QBR is Nov 13.
	R5 Jess, Writer	Close		Close the ticket. Current available tools can support desired outcome.
1	R8 Sam, $400k software	Take	Me and CIO	The architecture, and the technology that supports it. Solidify which systems stay, and the licensing. Unlocks R3: which AI tools users have, and how that is billed, on one bill. • Immediately: email the Tableau vendor to cut the license to the 17 in use, especially since seats can be added during the term. Vendors usually honor that if we can prove the request was sent. • Google Workspace is an observation, not in scope. Interviews were on Google Meet, and an MX check showed Google for email. This pass uses the contracts in the extract.
2	R3 Priya, AI on the IT card	Take	Me	AI billing, from the R8 decisions. Due Nov 20.
3	R6 Mei, telemetry spec	Take	Me	Kickoff Dec 1.
	R4 Tom, fifth technician	Take	Me and CIO	Review historical tickets to identify what caused the 40% before a hire (could it be tickets from the warehouse? misconfigured alerts generating tickets? Non-IT items that needed to be re-queued?). Meet with the CIO to review before the budget reviews on Nov 20.
	R2 Marco, peripheral racks	Take	Me	I build it. Connect Zendesk through Fivetran, build the automation on Snowflake, and put it on a schedule. Last - not time bound. Nice to have.

Order of work. R7 leaves first. It has to go to the Infra queue. Then the numbered work on this desk. 1 is R8. 2 is R3, due Nov 20. 3 is R6, kickoff Dec 1. R2 and R4 are also on this desk, and they are not in that 1-3. R5 is a close, not a piece of work. Inside R8, notice is

already open: Tableau today, Dropbox Nov 15, Zoom Nov 16, Copilot Nov 30 and it does not auto-renew, LastPass Dec 1, NetSuite and Salesforce Dec 30.

Handoff. R7 to Infra. R1 to Data Platform. Same steps for both. Write the request down. Check in with the owner before it is sent. Put a time on the calendar if it needs a meeting. Then send it.

What I am not doing. Not building the dashboard. Not fixing the Hannover WiFi. Writer closes on the note below.

Watchlist. A handoff still has to move. Hannover is in the Infra queue, with a next step, and orders are shipping. The dashboard is in the Data Platform queue ahead of the Nov 13 QBR. R3 is due Nov 20. R6 kicks off Dec 1. The notice dates stay on the list until the renewal is handled. I would still add myself as to the ticket watchlist to keep track of it.

Is $400k real in 2027?

On this set: **$403,296** out of the 2027 budget, **$469,979** every year after. The proposed mix is **$403,296** in 2027. That includes Salesforce down to the 151 people who used it, and 2 NetSuite seats still held by people who left. Leave Salesforce at 220 seats and the same cuts are **$288,760**. Cancelling Salesforce outright is past $400k, and it is a replacement project, not a renewal.

Trim seats	Cut + trim	Proposed
$267,940	**$657,046**	**$403,296**
in 2027 · $323,484 a year	in 2027 · $779,544 a year	in 2027 · $469,979 a year

Cut and a seat trim never both count on the same row. Seats start from people active in the last 90 days.

Tool	Act by	Increase	Bought	Active 90d	Seats	Cut	2027 saving	Yearly saving
Tableau 17 of 60 creators. Notice is today.	Nov 2 · now act this week	Up to 7%	60	17	17	☐	$35,413	$38,700
Dropbox Drive is the standard. 11 people in 90 days.	Nov 15 13 days	—	75	11	0	☑	$13,500	$13,500
Zoom Meet is in Workspace. Rooms become Google resources.	Nov 16 14 days	—	400	131	0	☑	$64,438	$67,200
Copilot Does not auto-renew. Drop empty seats. Ask for usage pricing.	Nov 30 28 days	—	150	86	86	☐	$14,592	$14,592
LastPass 288 still assigned, 31 of them former. Zero logins in 90 days. Notice by Dec 1.	Dec 1 29 days	—	300	0	0	☑	$21,600	$21,600

Tool	Act by	Increase	Bought	Active 90d	Seats	Cut	2027 saving	Yearly saving
NetSuite Drop the 2 seats held by people who left. Leave the rest.	Dec 30 58 days	Up to 8%	95	86	93	☐	$5,613	$6,695
Salesforce Idle seats are real and hard to get back. Not a rip-out.	Dec 30 58 days	Up to 7%	220	151	151	☐	$114,536	$136,620
DocuSign Keep the tool. Trim empty seats. Legal is a separate contract.	Jan 1 60 days	—	40	24	24	☐	$7,906	$8,640
Loom 31 of 120. Meet covers a lot of this.	Jan 1 60 days	—	120	31	31	☐	$14,659	$16,020
Grammarly Gemini is already in Workspace.	Jan 29 88 days	—	50	14	0	☑	$6,288	$7,500
Miro Trim to the 98 who use it.	Jan 29 88 days	—	180	98	98	☐	$13,199	$15,744
Gong Sales team. Trim toward the 34 active.	Jan 30 89 days	—	60	34	34	☐	$23,507	$31,200
Smartsheet 29 people. Ops can live in Sheets.	Feb 13 103 days	—	100	29	0	☑	$23,918	$30,000
Adobe Design seats. 22 of 45 opened it.	Mar 1 119 days	—	45	22	22	☐	$14,556	$19,320
Zendesk Support desk. Small trim. Keep the product.	Mar 1 119 days	—	85	71	71	☐	$14,556	$19,320
Lucid 58 of 140. Product already has Miro.	Mar 31 149 days	—	140	58	58	☐	$10,568	$15,744
Figma 39 of 42 editors. Leave it.	May 1 180 days	—	42	39	42	☐	$0	$0

Tool	Act by	Increase	Bought	Active 90d	Seats	Cut	2027 saving	Yearly saving
1Password The headcount tool. 771 active. Company is about 850.	May 1 180 days	—	850	771	771	☐	$4,447	$7,584
Microsoft 365 63 finance people still use it. Ask before cutting.	May 31 210 days	—	120	63	120	☐	$0	$0
Snowflake A commit, not seats. No usage in the extract.	Jun 30 240 days	—	commit	—	1	☐	$0	$0
Fivetran annual $ Not in the extract. Pipeline into Snowflake. No saving until the order is in hand.	mm/dd/yyyy Renewal, if known.	—	—	—	—	☐	$0	$0
Google Workspace Observation only. Not in scope. Interviews were on Google Meet. An MX check showed Google for email. Kept in case. Dollars stay with the contracts in the extract.	— Not in scope	—	—	—	—	☐	—	—

Known book $1,662,540. Fivetran is not in the extract. An amount entered there is the contract, not a saving. Google Workspace is an observation and is not in this book.

Proposed Program

Keep. 1Password, Zendesk, Salesforce, NetSuite (minus 2 former employees), Figma, Snowflake, Fivetran.

Cut. Zoom, Dropbox, LastPass, Grammarly, Smartsheet.

Fewer seats. Tableau, Copilot, Gong, Adobe, Loom, Lucid, Miro, DocuSign, Zendesk, 1Password. Copilot should move to usage pricing at the Nov 30 renewal. It does not auto-renew.

Other possible avenues for saving money: Fivetran and Snowflake are already in the environment. Open source can sit next to them: Twenty in place of Salesforce, DocuSeal for signing, Bitwarden in place of 1Password. That takes internal engineering and support. The support is the kind already provided, possibly at higher volume. The trade is more flexibility and less licensing. Salesforce is $435,600 a year, and it needs specialized staff. Consulting, from experience, runs about $275 an hour.

Twenty. Twenty is open source. It would sit next to tools already in the building: NetSuite for the books, Zendesk for support, and the order path for the warehouse. Signing has an open-source option too, DocuSeal, beside the DocuSign seats. Either job can also be built internally if the product is the wrong shape.

Notes & Questions

1. 1Password notes 771 active users (Okta for frontline staff Identity with personal email addresses?)
2. Google Workspace is an observation, kept in case, and not in scope. Interviews were on Google Meet. An MX check showed Google for email. This pass uses the contracts in the extract.
3. Fivetran isn't accounted for in the current budget. Need more info.
4. With data from HR (onboarding/offboarding), we can roughly estimate growth rate of staff and use the Growth % tool to figure out how licensing should be planned for future.

Note to Jess Lindqvist

> Hi Jess,
>
> Thanks for sharing the Writer proposal. We're working with Finance to determine a standardized approach to AI procurement across the company, so we cannot approve Writer at this time.
>
> That said, our technology team would be happy to partner with you and the Marketing team to better understand your content needs and explore how the AI tools we already have available could support your workflows.
>
> Please let me know if you'd be open to that. I'd be happy to coordinate a time to connect.
>
> Best,
> Erick